SUNY Old Westbury **2026-2027 Undergraduate Catalog**

English, B.A.

The English Department houses Old Westbury's Writing Program and offers the Bachelor of Arts Degree in English. The B.A. in English provides majors with a cutting-edge curriculum in the study of multicultural and world literature, creative writing, advanced writing and research, and critical thinking and analysis. The English program rigorously cultivates skills in literary analysis, careful reading, and advanced writing through a multicultural and global literary framework. Building on common foundations, this degree offers three upper-level specializations: Multicultural U.S.-British Literature, World Literature, and Creative Writing.

The English major is designed to give students: Knowledge of the main themes, historical/social backgrounds, periods of development, and genres of British/U.S. and European/World Literature, with specific knowledge of the multicultural and intercultural content of those literatures Ability to interpret literary texts with regard to themes, form, genre affiliations, and social/cultural reference Mastery of English writing skills, including the ability to construct large-scale interpretive-analytical papers that are proficient in grammar, expression, discussion of literary scholarship, and discipline-specific (MLA) documentation Ability to synthesize and integrate knowledge from different courses into an overall conception of the development and importance of Multicultural, World Literature, or Creative Writing.

At the Foundations level, requirements recognize the importance of firm grounding in Language Arts and Literary Interpretation. These emphases correlate with stress on skills foundations in current pedagogy. The Linguistic Foundations requirement recognizes the centrality of strong training in the history and structure of language as well as the formal grammar of English. The Literary Analysis requirement offers training in literary interpretation, close reading, knowledge of literary genres, social and historical contextualization of literature, and literary theory, today a sine qua non of competitive literature degrees. A three-course sequence in Literary Traditions includes historical surveys of British, U.S., European, and World literature and selected courses in classical foundations, genres, and such recent topics as postcolonialism.

The Multicultural U.S./British Literature Specialization is rooted in recent trends in literary theory and interpretation, which view U.S./British literature as expressing diverse national, cultural, and gender perspectives within a common tradition. Multicultural U.S./British Literature includes texts from both the U.S. and U.K. by writers of different ethnicities, genders, sexualities, classes, and ability/disability status. Multicultural literature focuses on the complexity of two countries in which people of many different cultures cohabit. Such fields as African American Literature, Multi-Ethnic Literatures of the United States, Women's Literature, and LGBTQ Literature, increasingly prominent in English studies since 1990, form the core of this

specialization. This specialization enhances the competitiveness of students applying to graduate English programs or continuing to a variety of careers.

The World Literature Specialization studies literature in English from outside the U.S./U.K. as well as other literatures in translation. This specialization speaks to the increasing integration of international literary culture and to an increasing emphasis on global culture. It is directly relevant to the sizeable number of Old Westbury students from postcolonial English speaking cultures and to others with an interest in world culture. It helps prepare students for graduate study in such fields as Postcolonial Studies, the Literature of the African Diaspora, and others, and for varied careers.

The Creative Writing Specialization provides students with an opportunity to read, study, and write literature. The specialization provides a foundation in creative writing in multiple forms, including short fiction, creative nonfiction, drama, and poetry. It also facilitates both creative and practical skill-building, critical thinking, and creative problem-solving through the process of workshopping and revising. The Creative Writing specialization enhances the competitiveness of students applying to graduate programs in creative writing or continuing to a variety of careers.

The Senior Seminar requirement offers an integrated capstone experience for students in this degree program. The Senior Seminar requirement begins with Senior Seminar I-Research and Writing, an intensive preparation for the Senior Thesis including study of advanced research methods, seminar presentations, and a semester-length writing project. Senior Seminar II-Thesis provides a semester-long thesis writing project with a common curriculum of reading and research.

The English Department offers co-curricular, community-building activities and systems of support for our majors through individual academic advising sessions; student publications, round tables and conferences; and workshops, poetry readings, and career networking sessions. The Department publishes *Harmonia*, a creative writing journal, and *Discordia*, an academic writing journal, open to all Old Westbury students. Majors have opportunities to earn course credit as peer mentors and as peer tutors. Internships place students in legal, cultural and publishing venues under the supervision of professionals.

The B.A. Degree in English program prepares majors for entrance into graduate school as well as for employment in fields that require strong proficiency in communication, writing, critical analysis, and intercultural understanding. Our graduates work in fields such as publishing, banking, education, business, library sciences, teaching, and law. Our graduates have continued their education, pursing graduate degrees in English, Education (including Old Wesbury's Master of Arts in Teaching English Language Arts 7-12), Library Science, Business Law, and other fields of study. The English Department is equally dedicated to developing the language arts skills of Old Westbury students (including writing, revising, reading, researching, information management, public speaking, and critical thinking) through our offerings of English Composition I and II. Faculty value involvement in campus life and reflect the university's social justice mission in our approaches to teaching, service, and professional development.

Program Policies

- Up to 3 transfer courses may apply toward the forty-four credits required for the major.

- Only one grade of C- will be accepted toward the major.
- EL3500: Literature Across Cultures I and EL3510: Literature Across Cultures II are pre-requisites for EL4800: Major Authors.
- Students are usually ready to register for EL5000: Senior Seminar I if all of the following apply: 1. students have completed 88 credits, 2. students have completed at least 5 courses in the English major (excluding EL3010: Structure and Grammar), and 3. students generally take and pass 4 courses per semester; if students take a part-time load, adjust the timeframe.
- EL5010: Senior Seminar II is usually offered in the summer. Students are eligible to register for the course in the summer under two conditions: 1. students need only EL5010 to graduate or 2. students need only EL5010 and one additional course (total of 8 credits) to graduate. Students must get the department chair's approval to register.

Combined B.A. in English, M.A. in Liberal Studies

The combined B.A. in English, M.A. in Liberal Studies program allows qualified undergraduate students to accelerate their progress toward a master's degree. This can save time and cut overall tuition costs. Applicants will major in English at the undergraduate level and complete the requirements for that B.A. degree, while beginning a portion of the graduate M.A. in Liberal Studies program in their senior year. For more information, visit the MALS web page: https://www.oldwestbury.edu/programs-courses/liberal-studies-ma.

Requirements for a B.A. Degree in English

(120 credits, 90 in liberal arts):

Liberal Education Curriculum

Refer to the Liberal Education Curriculum Bulletin for specific requirements.

Major Requirements:

All students in the major take a set of platform courses (levels 1 - 3) and complete the Senior Seminar sequence (level 5). Students choose one of two specializations, **U.S. -British Multicultural Literature or World Literature**, at level 4. Summaries of the areas and credits are as follows:

Prerequisites: EMS for all courses at 3000 level or above.

Distribution Requirements:

a. At least 2 courses primarily in literature written before 1800 (for the U.S., 1900)

b. At least 1 course in each of: British Literature; U.S. Literature; and World Literature. Either EL 3500 or EL 3510 may be used to satisfy the British or U.S. Literature requirement, but not both.

Grade Requirement:

A maximum of one grade of C-, and no grade below C-, may be counted toward satisfying the Major requirements.

Note: Not all courses are offered in any semester. Consult course descriptions and online class schedules.

B.A. in English: 44 Credits

1. Linguistic Foundations 4 credits
2. Literary Analysis 8 credits
3. Literary Traditions 12 credits
4. Specializations 12 credits
    a. **U.S.-British Multicultural Literature**
    b. **World Literature**
5. Senior Seminar 8 credits

Structure and Sequence of Courses:

Linguistic Foundations

- EL 3010 - Structure and Grammar of English Credits: 4

Literary Analysis (choose two):

- EL 3500 - Literature Across Cultures I: Analysis Credits: 4
- EL 3510 - Literature Across Cultures II: Theory Credits: 4
- EL 4400 - Critical Theory Credits: 4

Literary Traditions

(select one From Group A, one from Group B, and one from Group A, B, or C)

A. British and U.S. Literature:

- EL 3600 - U.S. Literature I-Colonial Period to Civil War Credits: 4
- EL 3610 - U.S. Literature II-Civil War to the Present Credits: 4
- EL 3800 - English Literature I: Beowulf to 18th Century, inclusive of Shakespeare Credits: 4
- EL 3810 - English Literature II: Romantics to Present Credits: 4

B. World Literature:

- EL 3560 - Literatures of Europe, Part I: Old Testament and Homer to the Renaissance Credits: 4
- EL 3561 - Literatures of Europe, Part II: Age of Enlightenment to the Present Credits: 4
- EL 3700 - Survey of World Literature Credits: 4

C. Genres and Traditions, Multicultural and World Literature:

- EL 3950 - Creative Non-Fiction Credits: 4
- EL 4200 - Biblical/Classical Influences on Multicultural Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4300 - Twentieth-Century Literature: Colonialism and Post Colonialism Credits: 4
- EL 4311 - Greek Drama Credits: 4
- EL 4312 - Greek Mythology Credits: 4
- EL 4325 - Shakespeare: Selected Plays Credits: 4
- EL 4500 - Topics in British/U.S. Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4510 - Modern Drama and Theater Credits: 4
- EL 4520 - Reading and Writing the Short Story Credits: 4

Specializations: Choose Multicultural U.S.-British Literature, World Literature, OR Creative Writing

Multicultural U.S.-British Literature Specialization:

A. Electives. Choose any two from these groups:

British/U.S. Literature

- EL 4030 - Women and Narrative Credits: 4
- EL 4050 - Lesbian and Gay Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4060 - Literature of Class and Class Consciousness Credits: 4
- EL 4080 - Extraordinary Bodies: Disability in Literature Credits: 4

U.S. Literature

- ML 3410 - Latino/a Writers in the United States Credits: 4
- EL 3811 - Survey of African American Literature
- EL 4000 - Native American Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4010 - The Harlem Renaissance Credits: 4
- EL 4015 - Multi-Ethnic Literatures of the United States Credits: 4
- EL 4020 - Asian American Literature Credits: 4

- EL 4040 - Black Women Writers Credits: 4
- EL 4070 - Topics in African American Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4090 - The Afro-American Novel Credits: 4
- EL 4091 - Afro-American Poetry and Plays Credits: 4
- EL 4405 - Caribbean Literature Credits: 4

British Literature

- EL 4550 - Modern British Literature 1890 - 1960 Credits: 4
- EL 4560 - Multicultural British Literature since 1960 Credits: 4

B. Required for all students in the specialization:

- EL 4800 - Major Authors Credits: 4

World Literature Specialization:

Note: Non-English Literatures are read in translation.

A. Surveys-Choose one:

- EL 3865 - Literature of Asia Credits: 4
- EL 3870 - Literatures of Africa Credits: 4
- EL 3880 - Masterpieces of Hispanic Literature Credits: 4
- ML 3880 - Masterpieces of Hispanic Literature Credits: 4

B. Electives-Choose two:

- EL 4405 - Caribbean Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4600 - Literature of India Credits: 4
- EL 4630 - Latin American Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4640 - French Literature Credits: 4
- EL 4650 - Literature of Russia and Eastern Europe Credits: 4

Creative Writing Specialization:

A. Required for all students in the specialization:

- EL 3901 - Introduction to Creative Writing Credits: 4

B. Electives–Choose two:

- EL 3920 - The Art of Writing Poetry Credits: 4
- EL 3950 - Creative Non-Fiction Credits: 4
- EL 4100 - English Internship Credits: 4
- EL 4520 - Reading and Writing the Short Story Credits: 4

Senior Seminars

[1]*Prerequisite for EL 5000: EMS, Senior Standing. Prerequisite for EL 5010: EMS, Completion of EL 5000.*

- EL 5000 - Senior Seminar I: Research and Writing Credits: 4 [1]
- EL 5010 - Senior Seminar II: Thesis Credits: 4

General Electives: In consultation with academic adviser, for a total of 120 Credits.

Policy on repeat courses in the English major: No EL course may be taken more than two times without the permission of the chair.

Courses in Composition

The Department of English offers a range of courses in composition. All courses are designed to develop facility in reading and writing and to sharpen critical thinking, listening, oral communication, research and study skills. These English courses fulfill SUNY-mandated General Education requirements in Basic Communication as well as the twocourse Old Westbury collegewide Writing requirement. EL 1000 - English Composition I: Exposition, concentrates on language development and rhetorical models. For English Composition II: Argumentation/Literary Perspectives, the Department offers a diverse set of thematically organized courses numbered between EL 2200 and EL 2299. These courses offer further training in expository writing and introduce students to research skills and scholarly documentation. All EL 2200-EL 2299 courses train students in the same skill sets, while offering variety in literary focus. For students needing additional work in English Composition at either the Composition I or Composition II level, EL 1010 - Writing Workshop (2 credits), provides practice in effective writing and reading strategies as well as one-onone tutoring sessions with their instructor.

EL 1000 and EL 2200-EL 2299 also fulfill SUNY-mandated assessment requirements in Oral Communication, Information Management, and Revision.

A grade of C or better is required to pass EL 1000 and EL 2200-EL 2299.

Liberal Education Curriculum Courses

Most but not all courses above the 2200 level courses fulfill Liberal Education Curriculum Domain requirements in the areas of Humanities and/or Diversity. Consult the Liberal Education Curriculum Bulletin or speak with a Department adviser for

guidance.

Non-Major Electives

- EL 2001 - Public Speaking Credits: 4
- EL 2310 - Introduction to Literature Credits: 4
- EL 2350 - Reading and Writing for a Multicultural Community Credits: 4
- EL 3901 - Introduction to Creative Writing Credits: 4
- EL 3930 - Language and Communications Skills for Educators: Issues and Applications Credits: 4